

Alyssa Smith

Curriculum Vitae

Network Science Institute
Northeastern University
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Research Interests

social media, network science, computational social science, natural language processing.

Education

- 09/2021–
Present **PhD Candidate, Network Science, Northeastern University**, Boston, MA.
Supervisors: Brooke Foucault Welles & David Lazer
Dissertation: Emergent Power in Information Ecosystems on Social Media
- 09/2021–
08/2023 **Master of Science, Network Science, Northeastern University**, Boston, MA.
- 09/2013–
05/2017 **Bachelor of Science, Humanities and Engineering with Computer Science and Comparative Media Studies, MIT**, Cambridge, MA.
Thesis: The Discourse: An Online Debate

Fellowships, Awards, and Distinctions

- 07/2025 **UC Berkeley/Oxford Internet Institute Doctoral Consortium.**
- 06/2025 **International Communication Association Doctoral Consortium.**
- 03/2024 **Network Science Institute NetSeed Grant Recipient.**
Granted \$10,000 for a year-long project titled “An Annotated Dataset of Local and National U.S. News Articles about Transgender Issues”
- 03/2023 **NSF GRFP Fellowship Awardee.**
in Social Sciences - Computationally Intensive Research. Awarded \$159,000 for five years of graduate study under Grant No. 1938052

Publications

Book Chapters

- 12/2025 **Adina Gitomer, Alyssa Smith, Hana Chalmers, Larissa Doroshenko, Robin A. Lange, Alex Madaras, Ryan J. Gallagher, Tamanna Urmi, Brooke Foucault Welles**, Social Movements in the Digital Age, in the *Handbook of Computational Social Science*, December 2025, pages 424 - 437.

Peer-Reviewed Publications & Accepted Articles

- 02/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas W. Landry**, A Blue Start: A large-scale pairwise and higher-order social network dataset, Accepted to *Nature Scientific Data*, February 2026.
- 02/2026 **Gerardo Flores, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Abigail E. Schiff, Julia Fukuyama, Ashia C. Wilson**, A Consequentialist Critique of Binary Classification Evaluation Practices: Theory, Practice, and Tools, Accepted to *AISTATS 2026*.
- 11/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, Locating the Asymmetry in Information Flow between Local and National Media on Transgender Discourses, *Bulletin of Applied Transgender Studies*, November 2025.

- 09/2025 **Gerardo Flores, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Julie Fukuyama, Ashia C. Wilson**, Aligning Evaluation with Clinical Priorities: Calibration, Label Shift, and Error Costs, *NeurIPS 2025*.
- 04/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, Brooke Foucault Welles, David Lazer**, Emergent structures of attention on social media are driven by amplification and triad transitivity, *PNAS Nexus*, April 2025.
- 04/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, It Has Been Handled: A Story about Ruling Relations and Power in the University Setting, *Journal of Autoethnography*, April 2025.
- 12/2023 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Adina Gitomer, and Brooke Foucault Welles**, You want a piece of me: Britney Spears as a case study on the prominence of hegemonic tales and subversive stories in online media, *First Monday*, December 2023.
- 11/2021 **Vibhu Bhatia, Vidya Prasad Akavoor, Sejin Paik, Lei Guo, Mona Jalal, Alyssa Smith, David Assefa Tofu, Edward Edberg Halim, Yimeng Sun, Margrit Betke, Prakash Ishwar, and Derry Tanti Wijaya**, OpenFraming: Open-sourced Tool for Computational Framing Analysis of Multilingual Data., in Proceedings of the 2021 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing: System Demonstrations, pages 242-250, Online and Punta Cana, Dominican Republic, November 2021. Association for Computational Linguistics..

Preprints

- 12/2025 **Sharaj Kunjar, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Tyler R. Mckenzie, Rushali Mohbe, Samuel V. Scarpino, Brooke Foucault Welles**, Computational frame analysis revisited: On LLMs for studying news coverage, *arXiv Preprint*.
- 05/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas W. Landry**, A Blue Start: A large-scale pairwise and higher-order social network dataset, *arXiv Preprint*.

Datasets

- 01/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas W. Landry**, A Blue Start: A large-scale pairwise and higher-order social network dataset, *SOMAR at ICPSR*.

Invited Talks

- 12/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Analyzing Online Structures of Attention*, Women in Network Science (WiNS) Seminar Series.
- 11/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Analyzing Online Structures of Attention*, College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA.
- 05/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Emergent structures of attention on social media are driven by amplification and triad transitivity*, Brown University CNTR Reading Group, Providence, RI.

Conference Presentations

- 10/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, *An Annotated Dataset of U.S. Transgender News For Determining Agenda-Setting & Information Flows*, Computation and Journalism Symposium, Boston, MA.
- 07/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, *Locating the Asymmetry in Information Flow between Local and National Media on Transgender Discourses.*, International Conference on Computational Social Science, Philadelphia, PA.
- 07/2023 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Attention Brokers: Adapting the Tertius iungens to an Amplification Paradigm*, Sunbelt, Portland, OR.
- 04/2023 **Rahul Bhargava, Hayden DelCiello, Zhen Guo, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Pardon Our Dust: Public Data Infrastructure Under Construction*, Digital Humanities Symposium, Cambridge, MA.

06/2022 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Attentional Cat-pital: Jorts The Cat's Disruption of Triad Closure Processes in Social Networks*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science, Cambridge, MA.

Posters

08/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas Landry**, *A Blue Start: An Open Network Data Resource*, Political Networks and Computational Social Science Conference, Cambridge, MA.

07/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ahana Bhattacharya, Holliday Sims, Kenneth Joseph**, *An Analysis of the Ecosystems of Elites on American Twitter in 2020*, International Conference on Computational Social Science, Philadelphia, PA.

06/2021 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Doing Data Science With Queer Identities*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science), Online.

Workshops

06/2021 **Layla Hashemi, Amy Magnus, Temitayo Osinubi, and Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Infograffiti*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science), Online.

Teaching

Fall 2025 **Guest Lecturer.**

PHYS 7332 (Network Science Data): I am serving as a guest lecturer in this course for Fall 2025, providing specific instruction on SQL and machine learning.

Fall 2024 **Co-instructor.**

PHYS 7332 (Network Science Data): This was a graduate-level course with 9 students enrolled. We focused on building competency in Python and related data science tools for network analysis, working with an eye towards scalability and reliability.

Spring 2023 **Guest Lecturer.**

NULab Digital Humanities Project Seminar

Spring 2022 **Guest Lecturer.**

SOCL 4600: Sociology Senior Seminar

Departmental Service

2024 - 2025 **Founded cross-disciplinary mentorship program now on its second cohort of mentorship pods**, Network Science Institute.

2024 **Led job interview practice group**, Network Science Institute.

2024 **Coordinated & moderated industry careers panel**, Network Science Institute.

2023–2024 **President**, Network Science Institute Graduate Student Association.

2022–2023 **Cohort Liaison**, Network Science Institute Graduate Student Association.

Professional Experience

May **Kayak Software Corporation**, Labs Data Scientist.

2019–May
2021 Built data pipelines and machine learning models. Led the LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Group

July **Kensho Technologies**, Graph Data Engineer.

2017–March
2019 Built data infrastructure for graph machine learning models

Service to Profession

08/2025 **Reviewer**, *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*.

06/2025 **Co-Reviewer**, *Nature Communications*.
03/2025 **Reviewer**, *ICWSM 2025*.
01/2025 **Program Committee**, *WebSci 2025*.
04/2025 **Reviewer**, *NetSci 2025*.
02/2024; 04/2025 **Reviewer**, *First Monday*.
02/2023 **Reviewer**, *Digital Humanities Quarterly*.

References

Prof. Brooke Foucault Welles (Co-Advisor): b.welles@northeastern.edu
Prof. David Lazer (Co-Advisor): d.lazer@northeastern.edu
Prof. Michael Ann DeVito (Committee Member): m.devito@northeastern.edu